HR and Leave Policy Handbook

Applicable to all full-time employees of Meridian Freight Technologies | Effective 1 April 2026

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1. Purpose

This handbook explains how MFT hires, rewards and supports its people. Where local law gives an employee a better benefit than this handbook, the law prevails.

2. Working Model

- MFT follows a **hybrid model**: employees in Pune, Chennai, Dubai and Singapore work from the office on **Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday**, and may work remotely on Monday and Friday.
- Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM including a one-hour lunch break.
- Customer-facing and support teams follow a rotating shift roster published every month.
- Employees may work fully remotely for up to **20 days per calendar year** with manager approval (for example, while travelling).

3. Probation, Confirmation and Notice

Topic	Rule
Probation period	6 months from the date of joining
Confirmation	Written confirmation after a positive review by the manager and HR
Notice period during probation	30 days
Notice period after confirmation	60 days (90 days for Director level and above)
Notice buy-out	Allowed with approval of the department head; recovered at basic salary rate

4. Leave Entitlements

Leave type	Days per year	Notes
Annual (earned) leave	22 working days	Accrues monthly; up to 15 unused days can be carried forward
Sick leave	8 working days	Medical certificate needed for more than 2 consecutive days
Casual leave	5 working days	Cannot be combined with annual leave for more than 3 days
Maternity leave	26 weeks	For the first two children; 12 weeks afterwards
Paternity leave	10 working days	Must be taken within 6 months of the child's birth
Bereavement leave	5 working days	For immediate family members
Marriage leave	5 working days	Once during employment

Leave rules

- Annual leave of 3 or more days must be applied for at least **10 days in advance**.
- Unused sick and casual leave **lapses on 31 March** and cannot be carried forward.
- At exit, up to **10 days** of unused annual leave can be encashed at basic salary divided by 26.
- Company holidays: 12 fixed holidays per year plus 2 floating holidays chosen by the employee.

5. Performance Reviews

MFT uses quarterly check-ins (informal, 30 minutes with the manager) and one formal annual review in **April**. Ratings are Exceeds, Meets, Partially Meets and Needs Improvement. Salary revisions take effect from **1 June** each year.

6. Learning and Referral Benefits

- Every employee receives a learning budget of **INR 40,000 per year** for courses, books and certifications.
- Employees with an approved certification must stay for 12 months after reimbursement or repay it on a pro-rata basis.
- Employee referral bonus: **INR 25,000**, paid after the referred hire completes 6 months. Senior leadership roles carry a bonus of INR 50,000.

7. Code of Conduct

- Treat colleagues, customers and drivers with respect; harassment of any kind is not tolerated.
- Report any conflict of interest to HR within 7 days of becoming aware of it.
- Gifts from vendors above INR 3,000 in value must be declined or declared.
- Concerns can be raised confidentially through the whistleblower mailbox, which is monitored by the Chief People Officer and the internal audit lead.

8. Disciplinary Process

Misconduct is handled in four stages: verbal counselling, written warning, final warning with a performance improvement plan of up to 60 days, and termination. Serious misconduct such as fraud, data theft or violence may lead to immediate suspension and termination after an inquiry.